

Bengaluru House Rent Prediction

<https://github.com/aiyshwary/Bengaluru-House-Rent-Prediction>

OVERVIEW

A supervised machine learning project that predicts rental prices of houses in Bengaluru using structured feature engineering, multi-stage outlier removal, and benchmarking six regression models with and without dimensionality reduction.

IMPACT

Built and benchmarked six regression models on the Bengaluru House Data dataset, finding that Linear Regression performed with the highest accuracy and Decision Tree Regressor performed best without dimensionality reduction, providing a robust prediction pipeline.

KEY DETAILS

1. Loaded and cleaned the Bengaluru_House_Data.csv dataset: dropped irrelevant columns (area_type, furnishing_status), removed null rows.
2. Engineered a BHK feature from the size column and normalized the total_sqft column by converting it to a percentile-based metric relative to their numeric average.
3. Created a price_per_sqft feature for outlier detection; removed properties with less than 300 sqft per room using $\text{mean} \pm \text{std}$ filtering.
4. Removed BHK outliers by comparing price_per_sqft of each BHK tier against the tier below within the same locality, identifying properties where bathrooms exceeded BHK count by more than two.
5. Encoded the location categorical feature using one-hot (dummy) encoding, grouping rare locations with fewer than 10 properties into an 'other' category to control dimensionality.

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6. Benchmarked Decision Tree, Linear Regression, and KNN regressors without PCA; then applied PCA and Random Forest ensembles (90 estimators) for each model.
 7. Applied RandomizedSearchCV with 5-fold cross-validation to tune Random Forest Regressor (200 estimators) for max_features, max_leaf_nodes, and min_samples_leaf.
 8. Key finding: Linear Regression with PCA achieved the highest overall accuracy; Decision Tree Regressor performed best among non-PCA models.
 9. Grouped rare locations appearing 10 or fewer times into an 'other' category, reducing unique location encoding.
 10. Removed bathroom outliers where bathrooms exceed BHK count by more than 2; final cleaned dataset ready for modeling.
 11. Visualized 2-BHK vs 3-BHK price scatter plots per location and price-per-sqft histograms with Matplotlib to assess model effectiveness.